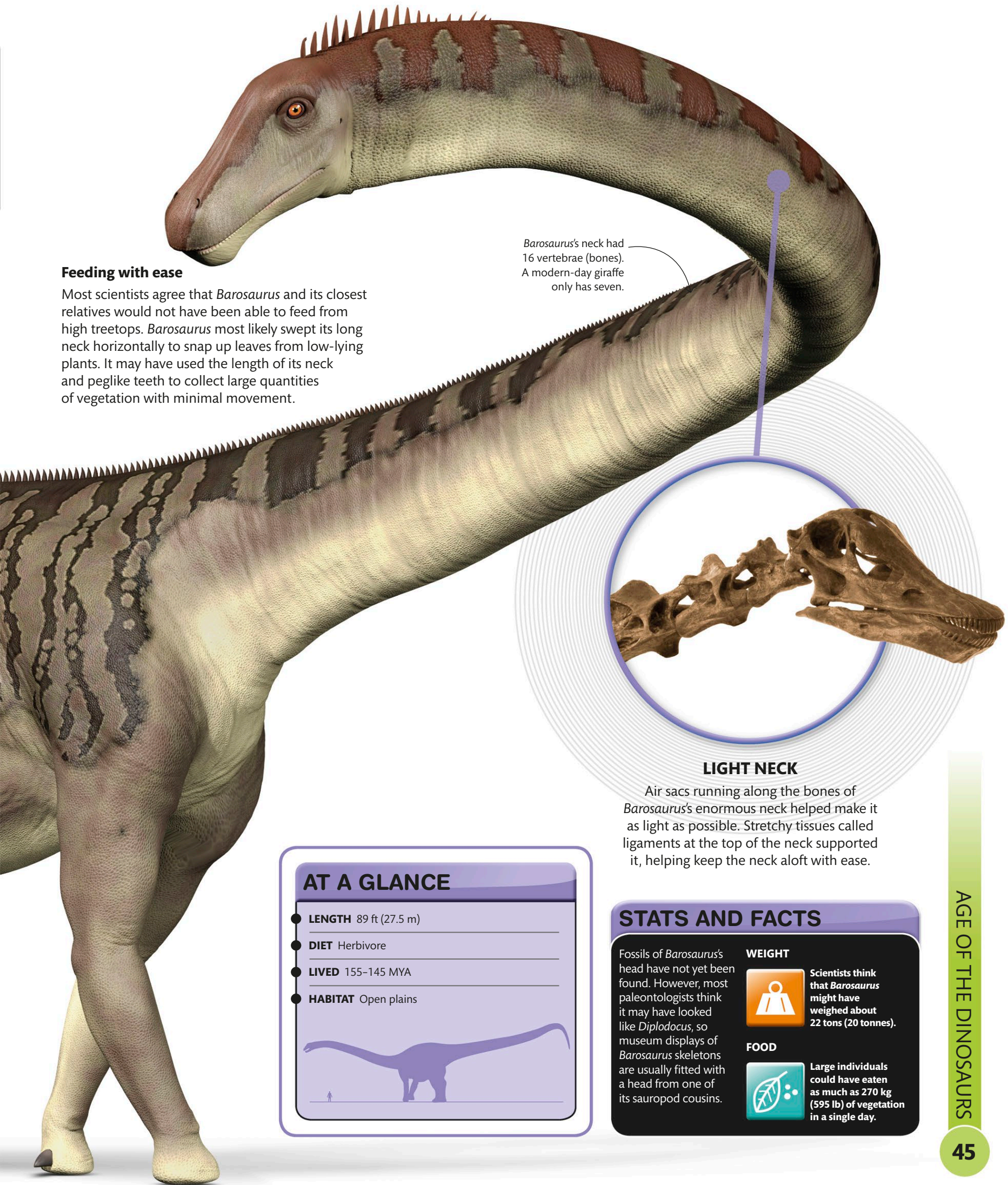




Barosaurus's neck had 16 vertebrae (bones). A modern-day giraffe only has seven.

Feeding with ease

Most scientists agree that *Barosaurus* and its closest relatives would not have been able to feed from high treetops. *Barosaurus* most likely swept its long neck horizontally to snap up leaves from low-lying plants. It may have used the length of its neck and peglike teeth to collect large quantities of vegetation with minimal movement.

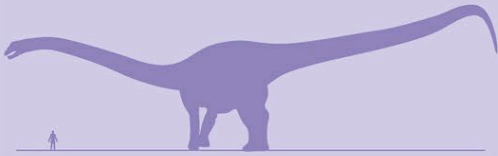


LIGHT NECK

Air sacs running along the bones of *Barosaurus's* enormous neck helped make it as light as possible. Stretchy tissues called ligaments at the top of the neck supported it, helping keep the neck aloft with ease.

AT A GLANCE

- **LENGTH** 89 ft (27.5 m)
- **DIET** Herbivore
- **LIVED** 155–145 MYA
- **HABITAT** Open plains



STATS AND FACTS

Fossils of *Barosaurus's* head have not yet been found. However, most paleontologists think it may have looked like *Diplodocus*, so museum displays of *Barosaurus* skeletons are usually fitted with a head from one of its sauropod cousins.

WEIGHT



Scientists think that *Barosaurus* might have weighed about 22 tons (20 tonnes).

FOOD



Large individuals could have eaten as much as 270 kg (595 lb) of vegetation in a single day.